

PROJECT NAHTAM (WE CARE)

NURTURING AUTISM ACCEPTANCE

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PROBLEM

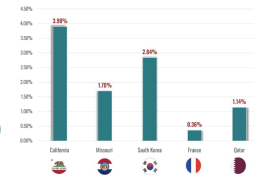
- Lack Of Sufficient Inclusion Of Students With Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD) Level 1 And 2 In Qatar's Primary Schools

HMW Framing

How Might We Increase Inclusion For Students With ASD Levels 1 And 2 In Qatari Primary Schools?

DATA AND STATISTICS

► 1.14 percent or 1 in 87 children in Qatar with autism



► 1 in 56 boys and 1 in 230 girls with autism spectrum disorder in Qatar

► 245,000 children in Qatar schools in 2017

► Estimates show that 2,450 out of 245,000 schoolchildren in Qatar have autism

EVIDENCE



Extensive research conducted by El-Ouarradi (2018) shows that programs currently in place in Qatar are limited and insufficient to support students with autism in schools.

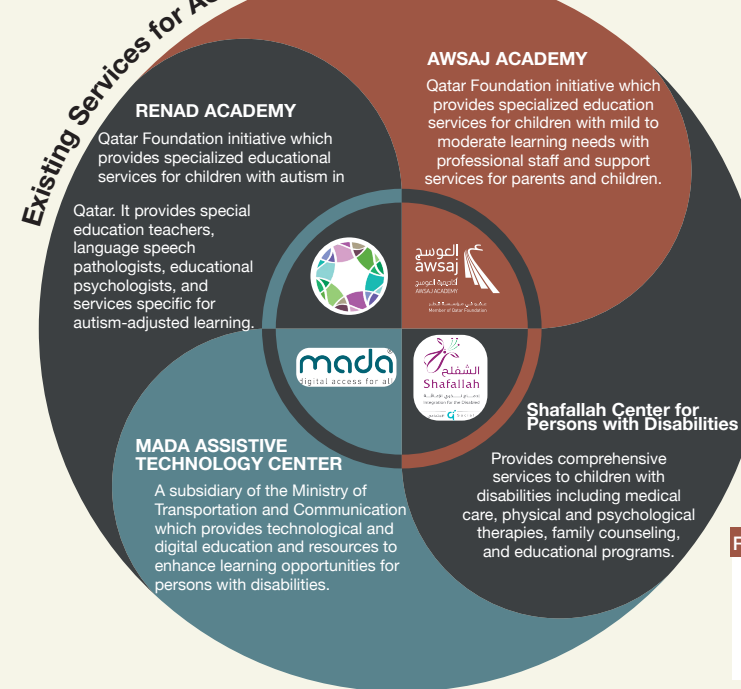


WISE Report (2017) shows parent dissatisfaction with partial inclusion of students with autism spectrum disorder in Qatar's schools.



Study conducted by Doha International Family Institute identified lack of inclusive schools as part of parent dissatisfaction (families want a more inclusive education system for their children with autism).

Existing Services for ASD Students in Qatar



WHY CO-DESIGN?

- The need for an inclusive, innovative, and participatory decision-making process to design effective policies on school inclusion for children with ASD levels 1 AND 2 with contributions from **relevant stakeholders and beneficiaries**.
- This is especially important because we want everyone's voices to be heard and to design policies **with people** and not just for them
- "A design-led process, involving creative and participatory principles and tools to engage different kinds of people and knowledge in public problem-solving." (Blomkamp, 2017)



STAKEHOLDERS

REFERENCES



وزارة التربية والتعليم والتعليم العالي
Ministry of Education and Higher Education
دولة قطر - State of Qatar



وزارة الصحة العامة
Ministry of Public Health
دولة قطر - State of Qatar

INPUTS

Team (Policy Consultants)



- Initiate, design, and execute co-design proposal.
- Hire project coordinator and social media manager.
- Monitor session outputs and online campaigns.

Qatar National Research Fund (QNRF)



- Funding for co-design process and activities.
- Budget allocation of \$50,000 for 12 months.

Ministry of Education and Higher Education (Special Education and Gifted Students Department)



- Meeting rooms for collaborative sessions.
- Stationeries, audio-visual equipment, and recreation centers.
- 2-4 officials as members of an advisory group.

Qatar Biomedical Research Institute (QBRI)



- 2-4 researchers and scientists for co-design.
- Provide data and findings on autism research.
- Share innovative tools for autism diagnosis, intervention, and treatment.

Qatar Autism Society



- 2-4 members participate in the co-design process.
- Provide information on awareness campaigns and support programs.
- Recommend support groups and social networks for autistic children.

Sidra Children's Hospital



- 3 child psychiatrists
- 3 child development psychologists.
- 3 pediatricians and 3 nursing staff.
- Provide medical diagnosis and expert opinions on autistic children.

Renad Academy, Awsaj Academy, Rajagir Public School, Birla Public School, Qatar Academy, and American School of Doha



- 6 school principals
- 8-10 teachers and teaching assistants.
- 4 behavioral analysts, 4 speech therapists
- 6 school nurses.
- Provide information on available and required resources in schools.
- Experiences, expectations, and challenges working with autistic pupils.

Imams and Teachers in Islamic schools

- 4 Imams and 4 teachers from Islamic schools.
- Provide Islamic recommendations for school policies.
- Provide teaching alternatives in classrooms.

Families and Domestic Assistants

- 6-8 families with ASD levels 1 and 2 children.
- 3-4 domestic assistants
- Fears and challenges of raising autistic children.
- Experiences, expectations, and hopes for the future of their children.

END USERS

- Students with ASD levels 1 and 2, parents, and caregivers (nannies and other domestic assistants).
- School boards and teachers in elementary schools.
- Professionals working with students with ASD levels 1 and 2.
- Organizations working with students with ASD levels 1 and 2.



OUTPUTS

- 01 systems analysis report.
- 12 meetings throughout the year, 1 meeting per month.
- 10 policy recommendations.
- 01 published paper.



OUTCOMES

Short-Term Outcomes

- Increased awareness about issues and problems faced by autistic children in Qatari schools.
- Improved skill sets and training for school staff and teachers in interacting with ASD levels 1 and 2 students.
- Increased collaboration among local organizations and educational institutions to increase inclusion of ASD levels 1 and 2 kids in Qatar.
- An increase in accessibility programs and initiatives for ASD levels 1 and 2 students.

Long-Term Outcomes

- Institutional systems and mechanisms of sustainable support of ASD levels 1 and 2 students in Qatari schools.
- Improvement in academic performance of ASD levels 1 and 2 students in Qatari schools.
- Better social ties and interactions between ASD levels 1 and 2 students and their peers.
- A benchmark of inclusive, culturally unique, and effective policies developed in Qatar and integrated into the elementary school system.

ACTIVITIES



2 Focus Groups



2 Debate Sessions



3 Community Consultations



Negotiations and Consultations Among Stakeholders and Participants



1 Advisory Group and 1 Secondary Group to Evaluate and Revise Policy Recommendations

People

- Policy consultants (team) to initiate and design the process.
- MoEHE and MoPH as stakeholders.
- QNRF and QBRI provide funding and research scientists.
- Schools, parents, hospitals, and social organizations as participants.

Process

- Focus groups and roundtable discussions as **tools** for dialogue.
- Workshops and debate forums as **techniques** to generate content data.
- Qualitative **methodology** to understand participants' perspectives.
- Principle of inclusion to guide collaboration among participants.

Place

- Systems analysis report and published paper as products.
- 10 policy recommendations to reform the education system once implemented.
- To provide an interactive platform for stakeholders at the WISH summit in Doha.

Practice

- Official letters, email correspondence, and visits to invite participants.
- Preliminary forum to prepare participants and outline specific goals.
- Iterative sessions to navigate complexities of co-design process.

